

CHALLENGE #16: Login Write-up.

login

Medium

Web Exploitation

picoMini by redpwn

AUTHOR: BROWNIEINMOTION

Hints ?

Description

(None)

My dog-sitter's brother made this website but I can't get in;  
can you help?

[login.mars.picoctf.net](http://login.mars.picoctf.net)

54,496 users solved

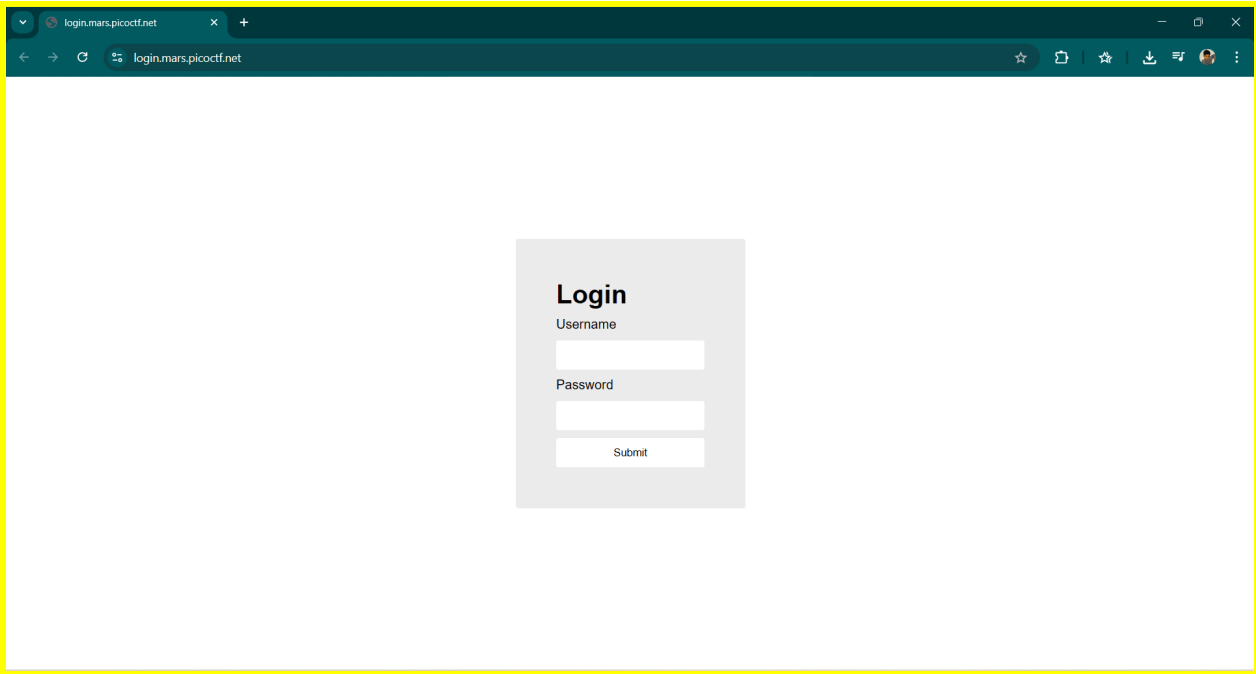
90%  
Liked

🚩 picoCTF{FLAG}

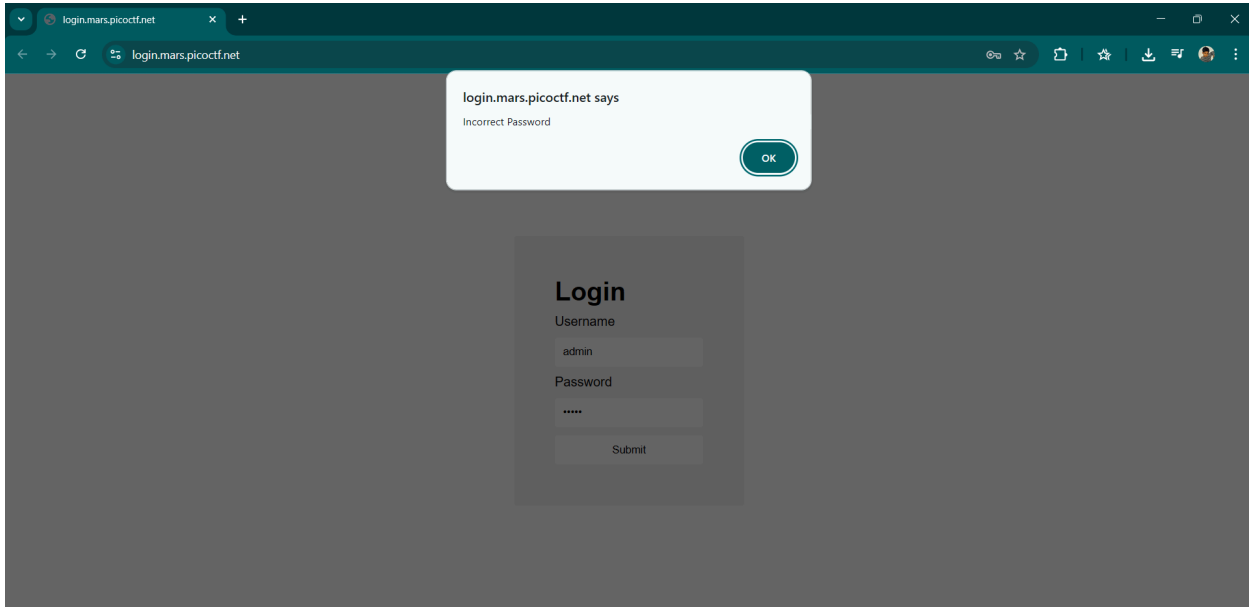
Submit Flag

Solving Process:

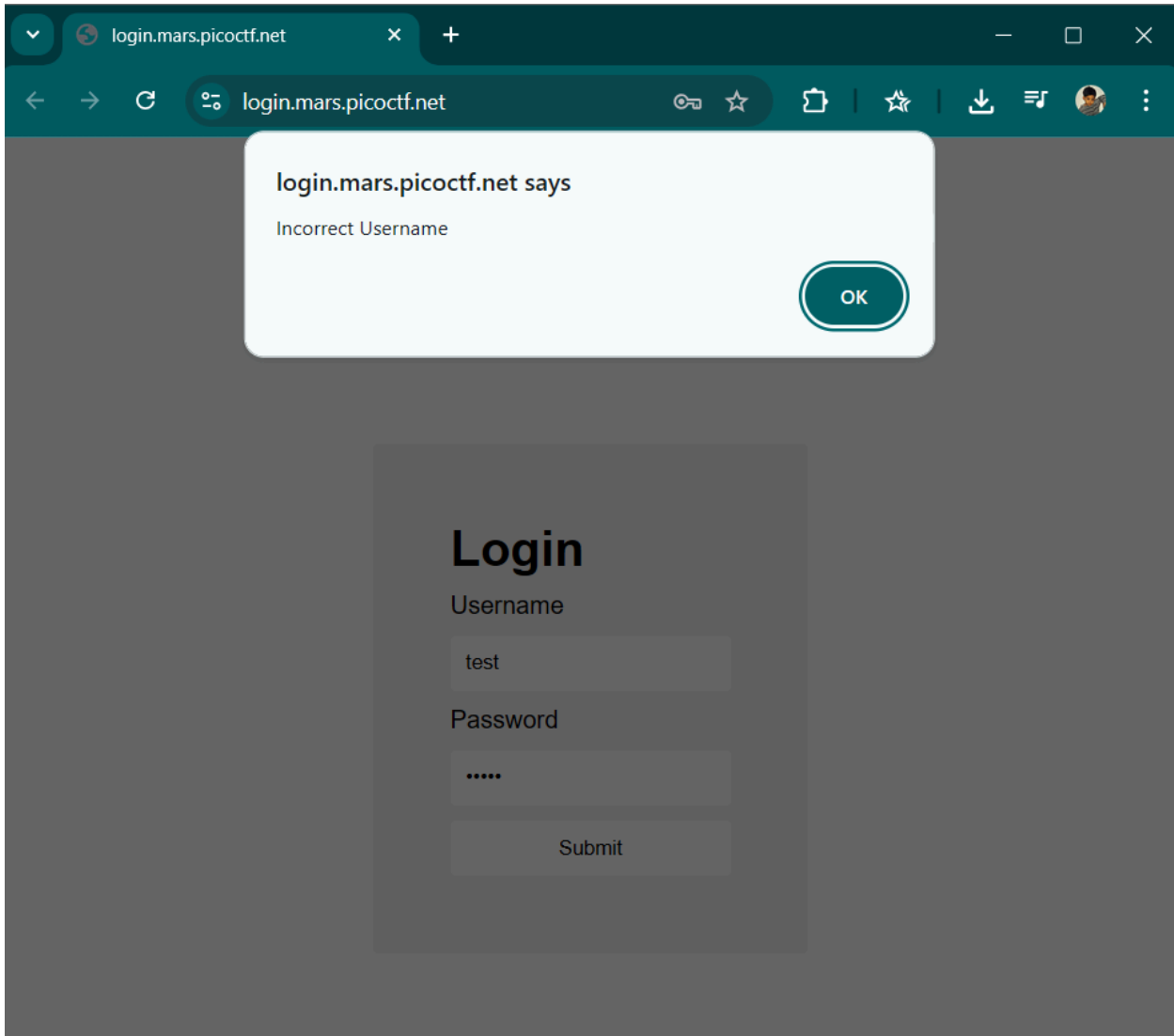
First, the challenge website was opened, which displayed a simple login form requiring a username and password. The goal of the challenge was to determine the correct credentials in order to retrieve the flag.



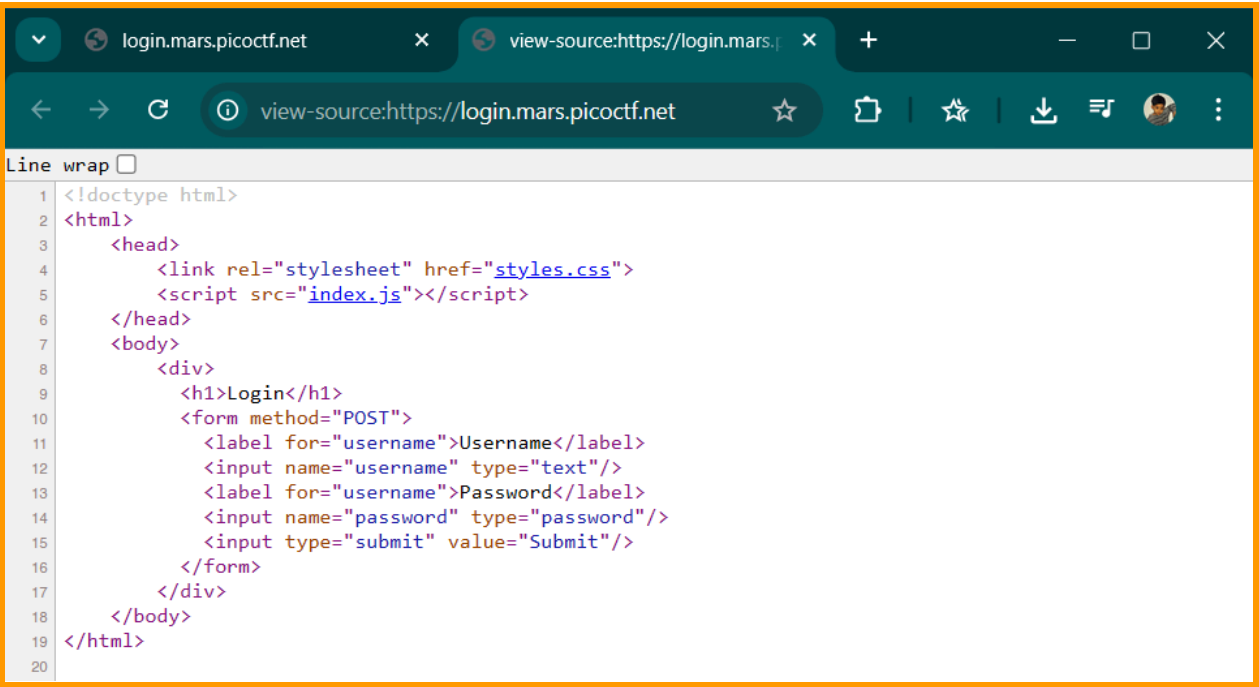
To begin testing, the username **admin** and password **admin** were entered. After submitting the form, the website returned the message “**incorrect password.**” This indicated that the username might already be correct.



To confirm this assumption, a different username was entered with the same password. This time, the website responded with “**incorrect username,**” confirming that the correct username was indeed **admin**.

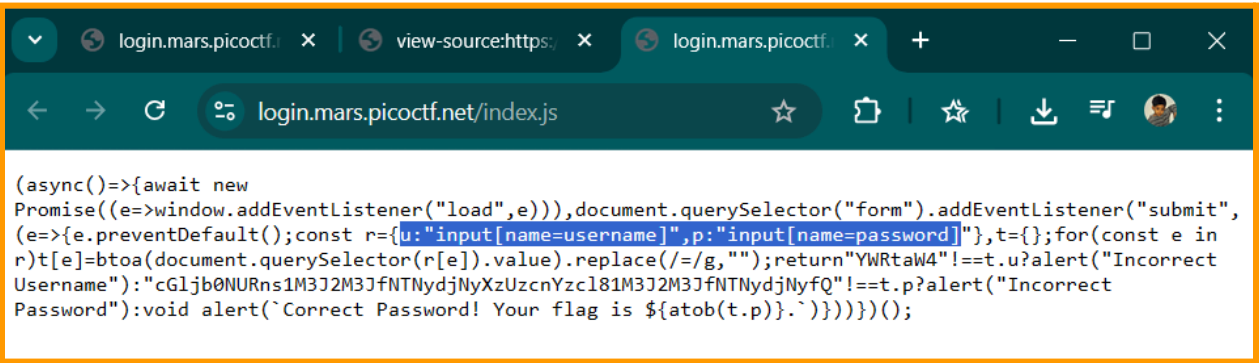


Since the password was still unknown, the next step was to inspect the website's source code. The source code showed that the page was connected to a CSS file and a JavaScript file.

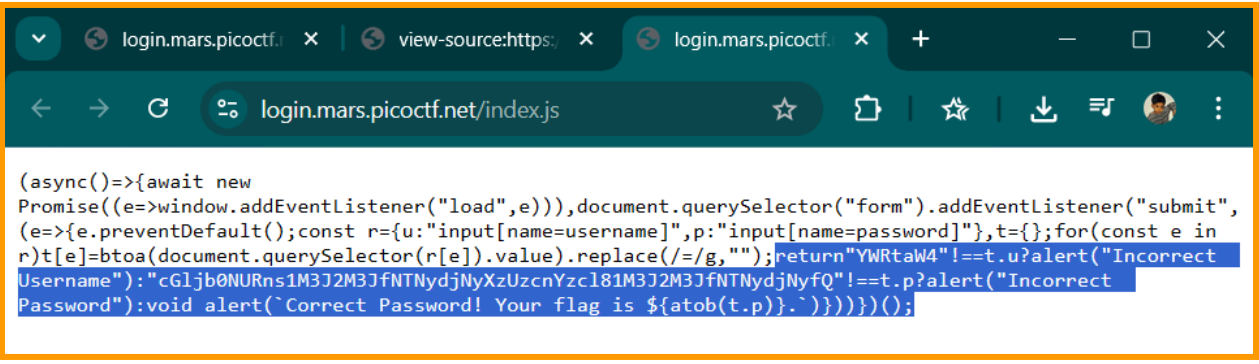


```
Line wrap
1 <!doctype html>
2 <html>
3   <head>
4     <link rel="stylesheet" href="styles.css">
5     <script src="index.js"></script>
6   </head>
7   <body>
8     <div>
9       <h1>Login</h1>
10      <form method="POST">
11        <label for="username">Username</label>
12        <input name="username" type="text"/>
13        <label for="password">Password</label>
14        <input name="password" type="password"/>
15        <input type="submit" value="Submit"/>
16      </form>
17    </div>
18  </body>
19 </html>
20
```

The JavaScript file (index.js) was then examined because it likely handled the login validation logic. Inside the script, variables were used to capture the **username** and **password** input fields. The code compared these inputs against two **encoded values**. If the entered username or password did not match the stored encoded values, the page would display either **“incorrect username”** or **“incorrect password.”** If both values matched, the script would reveal the flag.

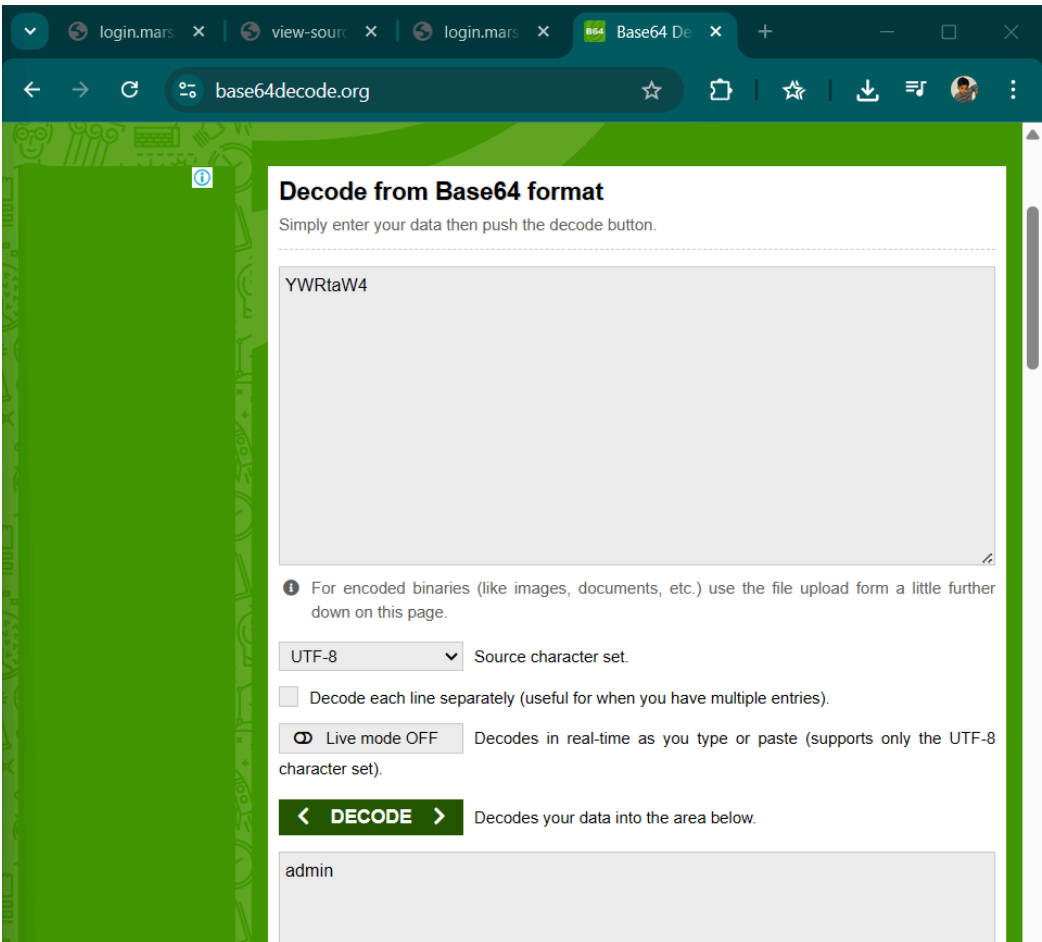


```
(async()=>{await new
Promise((e=>window.addEventListener("load",e))),document.querySelector("form").addEventListener("submit",
(e=>{e.preventDefault();const r={u:"input[name=username]",p:"input[name=password]"},t={};for(const e in
r)t[e]=btoa(document.querySelector(r[e]).value).replace(/=/g,"");return"YWRtaW4"!==t.u?alert("Incorrect
Username"):"cGljb0NURns1M3J2M3JfNTNydjNyXzUzcnYzc181M3J2M3JfNTNydjNyfQ"!==t.p?alert("Incorrect
Password"):void alert(`Correct Password! Your flag is ${atob(t.p)}.`)}))));
```

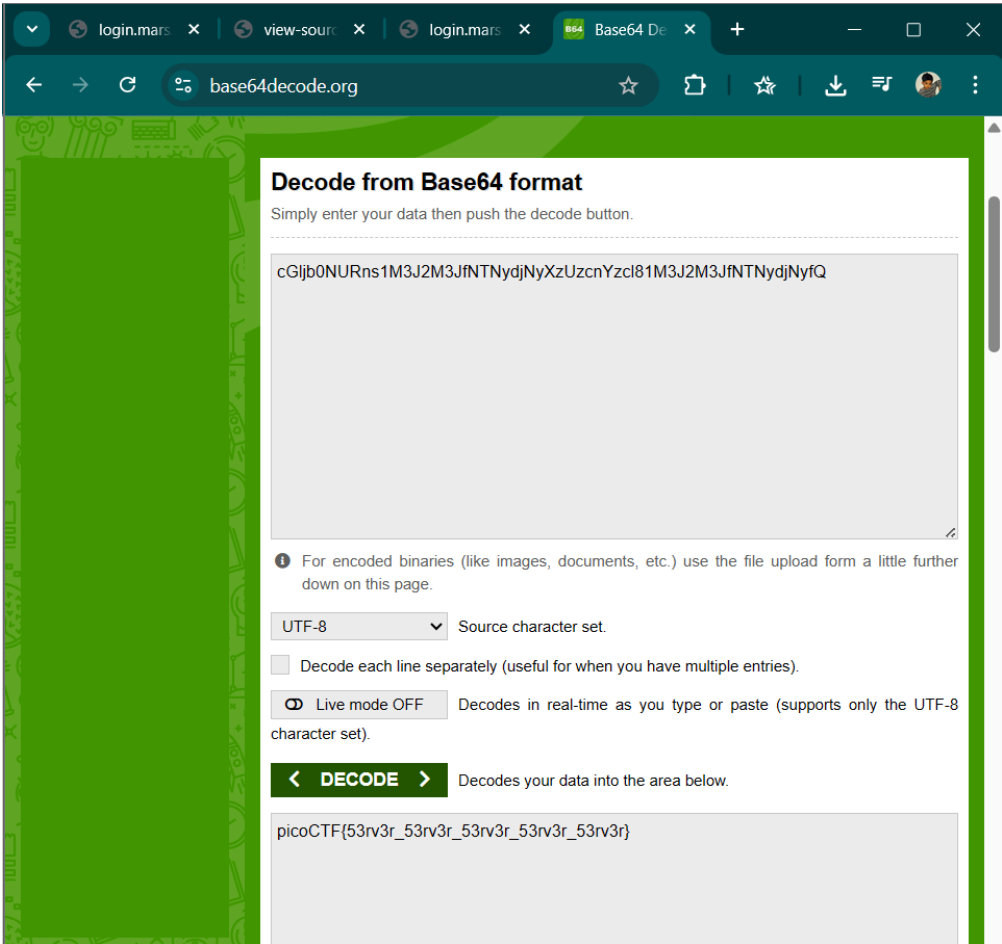


```
(async()=>{await new
Promise((e=>window.addEventListener("load",e))),document.querySelector("form").addEventListener("submit",
(e=>{e.preventDefault();const r={u:"input[name=username]",p:"input[name=password]"},t={};for(const e in
r)t[e]=btoa(document.querySelector(r[e]).value).replace(/=/g,"");return"YWRtaW4"!==t.u?alert("Incorrect
Username"):"cGljb0NURns1M3J2M3JfNTNydjNyXzUzcnYzc181M3J2M3JfNTNydjNyfQ"!==t.p?alert("Incorrect
Password"):void alert(`Correct Password! Your flag is ${atob(t.p)}.`)}))));
```

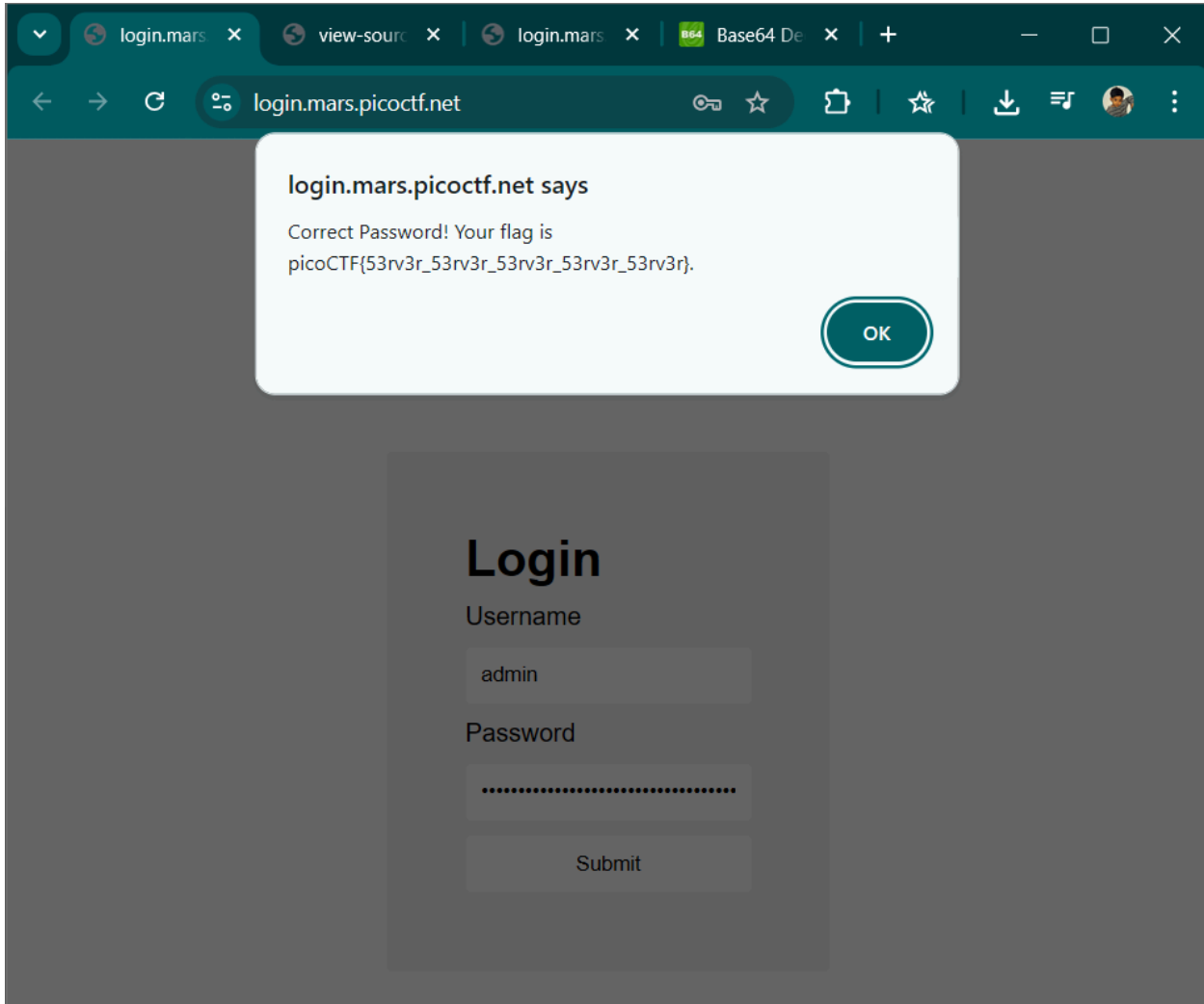
The encoded strings appeared to be Base64 encoded values. To verify this, the encoded username string from the script was copied and pasted into an online Base64 decoder. After decoding, the result revealed the username *admin*, confirming the earlier observation.



Next, the encoded password value from the script was copied and decoded using the same Base64 decoding tool. The decoded output revealed the password, which also appeared to be the flag.



Finally, the decoded password was entered into the login form together with the username admin, and the form was submitted. The website successfully authenticated the login and displayed a popup containing the flag, confirming that the correct credentials had been found.



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90% Liked

picoCTF{53rv3r\_53rv3r\_53rv3r\_53rv3r\_53rv3r}

Submit Flag

Hurray! You solved this challenge.

## Reflection:

This challenge demonstrated how sensitive information can be exposed when authentication logic and encoded credentials are stored in client-side JavaScript. By inspecting and decoding the values directly from the source code, the correct login credentials were easily discovered. The activity highlights the importance of keeping authentication mechanisms and sensitive data securely handled on the server side rather than the client side.